José Alberto Ferreira

European University Institute
Department of Economics
Via delle Fontanelle, 18
50014 Fiesole (FI), Italy

Email: Alberto.Ferreira@eui.eu
Website: jalbertoferreira.com
Date of birth: 27/03/1997
Nationality: Portuguese

Education

European University Institute *Florence, Italy*
PhD in Economics 2021–present

- Advisors: Russell Cooper and Giancarlo Corsetti
- Fields: Firm Dynamics, Macro-Finance

Research visit: Universitat Pompeu Fabra (EDP, hosted by Andrea Caggese), *Barcelona* (March–July 2025)

London School of Economics *London, United Kingdom*
MSc in Economics — specialisation in Monetary Economics 2018–2019

Nova School of Business and Economics *Lisbon, Portugal*
BSc in Economics 2015–2018

Exchange semester: Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien, *Vienna* (January–June 2017)

References

Prof. Russell Cooper
European University Institute
Russell.Cooper@eui.eu

Prof. Giancarlo Corsetti
European University Institute
Giancarlo.Corsetti@eui.eu

Working Papers

- ***Second Chances*: Bankruptcy Regimes and the Financing of the Intangible Economy**
  How do firms finance their growth in an increasingly intangible-oriented economy? While difficult to pledge as collateral today, intangible assets promise to generate future high cashflows. This has an ambiguous impact on firms' borrowing ability and growth. To address this, I develop a model where firms invest in different types of capital subject to adjustment costs and borrow under limited enforcement. By introducing a bankruptcy regime that promotes restructuring — as opposed to liquidation —, the lender can seize the going-concern value of the restructured firm. By preserving specific (i.e. difficult to redeploy) capital within the firm after default, restructuring-prone regimes favour intangible-oriented firms by opening up a channel of cashflow-based borrowing, which boosts investment and reduces cash holdings. The model is disciplined by a novel dataset that puts together detailed intangible capital accumulation by the universe of private firms in Portugal, linked with credit registry and court filings for bankruptcy. I show that firms with intangibles borrow more than those without, and are four times more likely to file for restructuring. Model-based simulations suggest that a restructuring-prone regime can partially offset the effects of real frictions (adjustment costs), raising investment and output. Moreover, it increases the take-up of riskier projects (more specific intangibles) while raising aggregate TFP — both via firm growth and firm selection.
- **Nonlinear Productivity Dynamics** *(with Marius Grünewald and David McCarthy)*
- **Dissecting the Decline in Investment Rates: Shocks vs. Responsiveness** *(with Chiara Maggi and Diaa Noureldin)*

Non-Academic Publications (incl. Policy Work)

- Portuguese Business Cycle Dating Committee (coordinated by Ricardo Reis), *Crises in the Portuguese Economy: from 1910 to 2022*, Fundação Francisco Manuel dos Santos (2024) [English · Português]
- **A. Ferreira**, J. Miranda and C. Yi (2025), "Firm Responsiveness over the Business Cycle: New Evidence from Europe", in the CompNet Productivity Report (April 2025)

Research Experience

International Monetary Fund — *Washington DC, USA*
PhD Intern — Research Department (RES-WEO) — July–October 2025

CompNet — Halle Institute for Economic Research (IWH) — *Halle, Germany*
Consultant: Firm Dynamics Research Lead and MDI Methodology Coordinator — 2024–present

European Central Bank — *Frankfurt, Germany*
Research Trainee to Dr. Kalin Nikolov — DG-Research / FIR — 2020–2021

Centre for Macroeconomics — LSE — *London, United Kingdom*
Research Assistant to Prof. Ricardo Reis — 2019–2020

Teaching Experience

European University Institute (Executive Education)

- Monetary Policy, Central Banking and Banking Supervision Programme (Class teacher): 2023–2024

London School of Economics (Undergraduate)

- EC210 — Macroeconomic Principles (Class teacher): 2018–2020 [student reviews]
- EC220 — Intermediate Macroeconomics (Class teacher, Summer School): 2019

Other Experience

Portuguese Business Cycle Dating Committee (FFMS) — *Lisbon, Portugal*
Scientific Advisor — reports & chronology — 2019–present

Kearney — *Lisbon, Portugal*
Summer Business Analyst — June–August 2018

European University Institute — Department of Economics — *Florence, Italy*
Researchers' Representative — 2021–2023

Nova School of Business and Economics — *Lisbon, Portugal*
Students' Representative, Pedagogical Council — October 2017–June 2018

Conferences and Seminars

2026 19th Meeting of the Portuguese Economic Journal
2025 CREI Macroeconomics Lunch; IMF Research Seminar; CompNet-TSI Concluding Conference

Workshops and Short Courses

Gerzensee — "How do Firms Behave?" *(D. Thesmar)* — June 2024
Barcelona School of Economics — "Firms in Macro-Finance" *(A. Caggese)* — July 2023
University of Oxford — "Tools for Macroeconomists" *(Den Haan, Sedláček, Rendahl)* — August 2020

Grants and Awards

Bolsa de Investigação — Portuguese Foundation for Science and Technology (FCT) — 2021–2023
La Caixa Postgraduate Fellowship Abroad *[declined]* — 2021
Excellence in Macroeconomics Award — LSE — 2019
Academic Merit — Nova SBE — 2018
Nova SBE–Novo Banco Excellence Scholarship (full tuition) — 2015

Other

Languages Portuguese (native), English (proficient), Spanish (intermediate), Italian (basic), German (basic)
Programming Julia, R, Python, Matlab, Dynare, Stata
Software Microsoft Office, LaTeX